ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Participle clauses

Participle clauses compress information without losing the logical connection, but their implied subject must match the subject of the main clause.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Condense two related ideas that share the same subject.

Reduce clauses of time, reason or result with -ing, a past participle or having + past participle when the implied subject is clear.

MODEL

Having finished the report, Maya sent it to the client.

-ing clause | past-participle clause | having + past participle

6 GUIDED STAGES · 29 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Reduce active and passive clauses.

OUTCOME 2

02

Mark clear anteriority with having + past participle.

OUTCOME 3

03

Prevent dangling participles by controlling the implied subject.

Build meaning before form

Reduce clauses of time, reason or result with -ing, a past participle or having + past participle when the implied subject is clear.

The subject-control rule

In Walking into the room, I noticed the silence, I performs both actions. In Walking into the room, the silence surprised me, the grammar accidentally suggests that the silence walked into the room.

This dangling-participle test is the first check to make before choosing any reduced form.

Active, passive and earlier actions

The -ing form carries active meaning. A past participle carries passive meaning. Having + past participle clearly shows that the reduced action finished before the main action.

The choice is therefore semantic as well as grammatical: decide who acts, who receives the action, and which action comes first.

Full clause	Reduced clause
Because she knew the answer, she replied.	Knowing the answer, she replied.
Because it was damaged, the device failed.	Damaged in transit, the device failed.
After he had signed, he left.	Having signed, he left.

How the logical link is recovered

A participle clause may express time, reason, condition or result. The reader infers the link from context, punctuation and the lexical meaning of both clauses.

If two interpretations remain equally plausible, keep the full conjunction instead of forcing a shorter form.

When not to reduce

Do not reduce when the subjects differ, when the sequence is unclear or when the compact form would overload the sentence. Concision improves prose only when clarity survives.

A full clause is often the more advanced choice when it prevents ambiguity.

Reason through the pattern

Three lanes reduce active, passive and earlier clauses. Every lane passes through the same-subject checkpoint before it reaches the final sentence.

01	02	03	04
-ing clause	past-participle clause	having	past participle

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Use a past participle for passive meaning.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Use having + past participle when the first action was completed earlier.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Form	Relationship	Example
-ing	active/simultaneous	Walking home, I called Ana.
past participle	passive	Built in 1890, the house needs repairs.
having + participle	earlier action	Having checked the data, we published it.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

because she knew	knowing
because it was damaged	damaged
after he had finished	having finished

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Leaving an implied subject that does not match the main subject.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Using -ing when the reduced idea is passive.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Reducing a clause when the logical relationship becomes ambiguous.

01 · PRACTICE STAGE

Recognition in context

Choose the form that completes each situation naturally.

A1 · CONTEXT 1

___ the figures, Maya sent the report.

OPTIONS Having checked · Checked by · Being check · Have checked

A2 · CONTEXT 2

___ in 1890, the station is now protected.

OPTIONS Built · Building · Having build · To building

A3 · CONTEXT 3

___ home, I ran into an old friend.

OPTIONS Walking · Walked · Having walk · Built

A4 · CONTEXT 4

___ the risks, they cancelled the launch.

OPTIONS Knowing · Known · Having know · Know

A5 · CONTEXT 5

___ by both parties, the contract became valid.

OPTIONS Signed · Signing · Having sign · Being signing

A6 · CONTEXT 6

___ the client’s approval, we began production.

OPTIONS Having received · Receiving after · Received · Have receive

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

02 · PRACTICE STAGE

Two connected decisions

Resolve two connected choices within the same context.

B1 · CONNECTED CONTEXT 1

_____ the last train, we took a taxi. _____ by the delay, the driver chose a faster route.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Having missed / Missed / Have missing · Gap 2: Warned / Warning / Having warn

B2 · CONNECTED CONTEXT 2

_____ the samples, the team found a pattern. _____ carefully, the results support the hypothesis.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Having analysed / Analysed / Analyse · Gap 2: Interpreted / Interpreting / Having interpret

B3 · CONNECTED CONTEXT 3

_____ everyone’s concerns, the chair revised the proposal. _____ in plain language, the new version was easier to approve.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Understanding / Understood / Having understand · Gap 2: Written / Writing / Have written

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided text

Maintain the target structure throughout a complete text.

C1 · GUIDED APPLICATION

_____ months of research, the team presented its prototype. _____ with recycled materials, the device attracted attention. _____ several faults during testing, the engineers delayed production. _____ the design, they ran a second trial. _____ by the final results, the client approved the launch.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

Completed · Completing after · Discover · Discovered · Having completed · Having discovered · Having make · Having reassure · Having revised · Made · Making · Reassured · Reassuring · Revise · Revised by

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open text

Supply every form without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT APPLICATION

After she had read the contract, she signed it. -> _____, she signed it. Because he was confused by the instructions, he called support. -> _____, he called support. While I was waiting for the bus, I checked my email. -> _____, I checked my email. Because the road was blocked, it remained closed. -> _____, the road remained closed. After they had reached an agreement, they issued a statement. -> _____, they issued a statement.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled production

Transform the idea without changing its meaning.

E1 · CONTROLLED TASK 1

Write an original Participle clauses response for context 1. Include having finished.

_____
_____

E2 · CONTROLLED TASK 2

Write an original Participle clauses response for context 2. Include surrounded by mountains.

_____
_____

E3 · CONTROLLED TASK 3

Write an original Participle clauses response for context 3. Include speaking to the audience.

_____
_____

E4 · CONTROLLED TASK 4

Correct: Driving to work, the rain started.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative mission

Use the structure in original responses and realistic situations.

F1 · COMMUNICATION TASK 1

Write an original Participle clauses response for context 1. Include having, guided, monitoring.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · COMMUNICATION TASK 2

Write an original Participle clauses response for context 2. Include built, restored.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · COMMUNICATION TASK 3

Write an original Participle clauses response for context 3. Include having checked.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: subject.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: active.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: passive.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: anteriority.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

Having checked

Use “Having checked”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

A2

Built

Use “Built”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

A3

Walking

Use “Walking”. Use a past participle for passive meaning.

A4

Knowing

Use “Knowing”. Use having + past participle when the first action was completed earlier.

A5

Signed

Use “Signed”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

A6

Having received

Use “Having received”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

Two connected decisions

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Having missed / Warned

Use “Having missed”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject. Use “Warned”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

B2

Having analysed / Interpreted

Use “Having analysed”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship. Use “Interpreted”. Use a past participle for passive meaning.

B3

Understanding / Written

Use “Understanding”. Use a past participle for passive meaning. Use “Written”. Use having + past participle when the first action was completed earlier.

Guided text

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

Having completed

Use “Having completed”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

C2

Made

Use “Made”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

C3

Having discovered

Use “Having discovered”. Use a past participle for passive meaning.

C4

Having revised

Use “Having revised”. Use having + past participle when the first action was completed earlier.

C5

Reassured

Use “Reassured”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

Open text

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

Having read the contract

Use “Having read the contract”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

D2

Confused by the instructions

Use “Confused by the instructions”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

D3

Waiting for the bus

Use “Waiting for the bus”. Use a past participle for passive meaning.

D4

Blocked

Use “Blocked”. Use having + past participle when the first action was completed earlier.

D5

Having reached an agreement

Use “Having reached an agreement”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

Controlled production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

Having finished the draft, I sent it.

Use “Having finished the draft, I sent it.”. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

E2

Surrounded by mountains, the village remained isolated.

Use “Surrounded by mountains, the village remained isolated.”. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

E3

Speaking to the audience, she noticed a familiar face.

Use “Speaking to the audience, she noticed a familiar face.”. Use a past participle for passive meaning.

E4

Driving to work, I noticed that it started to rain.

Use “Driving to work, I noticed that it started to rain.”. Use having + past participle when the first action was completed earlier.

Communicative mission

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

Having reviewed the evidence, we changed the plan. Guided by the data, we chose a smaller trial. Monitoring the results, we adjusted the schedule.

The model combines accurate Participle clauses with a clear purpose. Confirm that the reduced clause and main clause share a subject.

F2

Built in the 1920s and restored last year, the theatre now hosts concerts.

The model combines accurate Participle clauses with a clear purpose. Use -ing for an active or simultaneous relationship.

F3

Having checked the route, we left early; we both checked and left.

The model combines accurate Participle clauses with a clear purpose. Use a past participle for passive meaning.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____